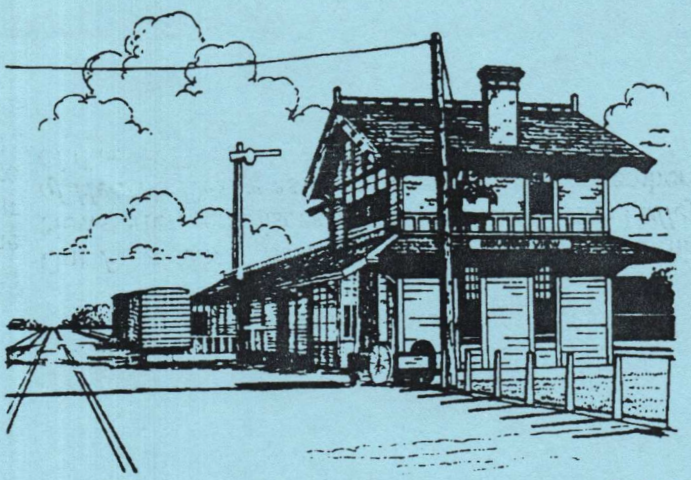
Mountain View Historical Association Newsletter

P.O. Box 252
Mountain View, CA 94042

Hilton U. Brown, III - Editor



Southern Pacific Depot — Mountain View, California, built in 1888

Eleventh Annual Barbecue & Raffle August 1, 2004

The August 1, 2004 meeting of the Mountain View Historical Association will be our Eleventh Annual Barbecue and Raffle. The place this year will again be the beautifully restored Adobe Building and its patio and lawn area.

For an eleventh anniversary, a little nostalgia may be pardonable. At that first BBQ in 1994 our membership was 225 including 16 Life Members. This year our membership has increased to 381, including 114 Life members. Along the way we noted the passing of 68 of our members most notably during the last year, Special Member Lena Marie Alameda and Life Member Eva Mockbee.

The membership was sent a flyer recently, reproduced as page three of this Newsletter, providing the menu and agenda for the meeting. If you lost or misplaced the flyer, don't despair! Let any of the officers know you're coming so that we can have the correct amount of food available.

The most important part of the affair is that hour of socializing and working up your appetite at the beginning of the meeting, so come early. Bring your friends, they will be welcome whether they are members or not. We'll see you on Sunday, August 1, 2004 at the Adobe building, for the *Eleventh Annual Barbecue & Raffle.*

Prunes and Apricots Agriculture in Santa Clara Valley The Sunsweet Story Presented by Mr. Richard Azevedo The May Meeting

Mr. Richard Azevedo's family and forebears were pioneers in raising prunes in Santa Clara Valley. Mr. Azevedo spent 39 years with the prune cooperative, eventually as a member of management of Sunsweet Growers in San Jose and Yuba City. He discussed the growth of the industry, the establishment of the farmers cooperatives such as Sunsweet, the changes that occurred over the years including the decline of the orchard period in Santa Clara Valley with the growth of World War II and the computer industry's forcing the movement to other areas in California such as Sacramento and the San Joaquin Valley.

Our *President's Message*, printed elsewhere in this Newsletter, reminisces about this period in the *Valley of Heart's Desire* as I am sure many other members of the MVHA do.

Mountain View's Loving Cup Returns Home

Reported by

Barbara Kinchen

Found in the basement of a home in King George, Virginia, was an old dirty, tarnished, 7" tall, metal cup with the following inscription:

PRUNE & APRICOT EXPOSITION

HELD AT
MOUNTAIN VIEW

FIRST PRIZE
FOR
IMPERIAL PRUNE

WON BY

DR. BARKER	1917
WM. BUBB	1918
C.F. GROSS	1919
J.A. PETERSON	1920
	1921

The John J. Donegan family, after 26 years in their King George home, were getting ready to move to South Carolina. Mr. Donegan, cleaning out his basement, found this interesting object. He had never seen it before and had no idea who might have placed it there. The inscription does not identify Mountain View as being in California but Mr. Donegan did contact our city and talked to Mayor Matt Pear. The cup arrive in April and the sender was properly thanked.

Recognizing the historical value of this trophy, Mayor Pear presented it to the Historical Association President Craig Holden for safe keeping.

The Mountain View Register Leader newspaper for Sept. 23, 1917 yielded interesting information about that year's Prune and Apricot Exposition. The two-day affair featured exhibits of farm and orchard products, flowers and needlework. There were foot races, cooking demonstrations and special sales in Castro Street stores.

Not only was there a parade of decorated floats and autos, but another called a "baby parade." Specifically mentioned were little Doris Awalt representing California with a yellow dress pushing her doll buggy, also in yellow, while Alice Spencer was in electric blue. Frances and Roberta Bubb (Our member, Mrs. Roberta Bubb Sweeney.) represented prunes and apricots, their dresses being made of colored crepe paper with hair ribbons to match. (Their father, Wm.F. Bubb was awarded the loving cup in 1918.)

"Silver loving cups" were given for best displays of Blenheim apricots, Moorpark apricots, French prunes, sugar prunes and Imperial prunes. The cups were to be give permanently to a person winning two years consecutively. Dr. A.M. Barker of Cupertino was the first winner for Imperial Prunes. In addition, over 400 ribbons were given other event winners.

The first of Mountain View's thirteen annual events was held September 4, 1915. The Commercial Club, an organization of business and professional men, wanted to promote local businesses, recognize the importance of the fruit industry and show off the club's newly-installed project — a huge sign across Castro Street, near the railroad tracks, with MOUNTAIN VIEW spelled out in electric lights. With free movies at the Glen Theatre and exhibits of fruit on display at the club's headquarters in the former Bank of Mountain View's building, "Bargain Day" was a complete success.

The next year there were more sponsors, additional activities, prizes, music street decorations and a dance. Produce exhibits filled the Commercial Club building and a stage was constructed at the corner of Castro and Villa Streets. Schools declared a holiday so students could participate in the parade and athletic events. It was apparent that this would become a yearly celebration, so a permanent committee was organized to plan ahead for the next "Prune and Apricot Day."

You already have read something about the 1917 affair which was held in two large tents just next to the City Hall at 401 Castro Street. Los Altos, Sunnyvale and Cupertino participated that year.

Each year more people came to exhibit, shop, visit and have fun. In 1919 activities were held in the large garage just competed for Redwine Automobile Company. It was a dry and secure location for the

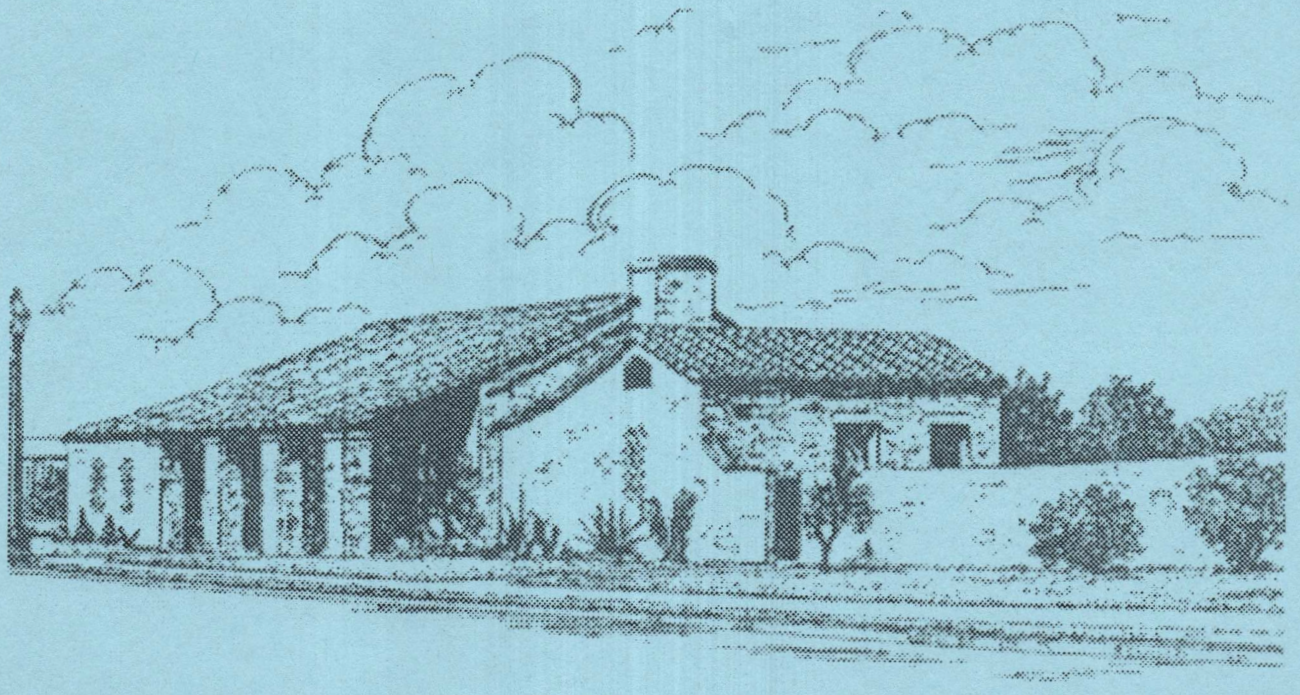
now three-day event. The next year Redwine's offered their old building for the Exposition.

The Exposition Association, in 1921, purchased property at Castro and Mercy Streets, where Mountain Bay Plaza now stands. Tents had to be used until a building was constructed two years later. Admission was charged, for the first time, to enter the tent exhibits. A street carnival and automobile and tractor show were new attractions.

Finally, in 1923 a permanent building housed the popular festival. The lumber came from a San Carlos racetrack after a fire had partially destroyed a grandstand.

The thirteenth annual Prune and Apricot Exposition, Industrial Fair and Automobile Show was held during a five-day period in September 1927. P. Milton Smith, editor of the Mountain View Register Leader told why this was the last Exposition held. "Street carnival companies had been employed as special crowd pleasing attractions, and the attendance grew into many thousands. Mr. Earl D. Minton had persistently caused the arrest of the street carnival people for conducting gambling games for two or three succeeding years." Smith goes on to say that Mr. O.W. Whaley, President of the Exposition for a number of years "became so disgusted with the whole thing that he announced that he was all through, and would never try to hold another exposition." Mr. Minton was Mountain View's mayor from 1924 to 1928, Mr. Whaley was associated with the local Farmers and Merchants Bank. In 1930 Redwine Motor Company bought the Exposition lot, did some remodeling and added an auto showroom and service station. A grand opening was on October 18, 1930. Previously the company had been located at 256 Castro Street, with the sale and repair of farm equipment at the corner of Dana and Bryant Streets. This latter building was changed into the Cinema Theatre. Pearson Automotive Company last occupied the exposition site, 1939 - 1964. Demolished in 1965, the new high-rise I.E.D. building was constructed there in 1970. As mentioned before, we know this as the Mountain Bay Plaza location.

The loving cup triggered this research about a part of Mountain View history. We hope soon to use it in an exhibit at the Library's Mountain View History Room. Do any of you readers have ribbons, pictures, or loving cups for that matter, we might include in a Prune and Apricot Exposition display?



President's Message

The summer season reminds me of my growing-up years in Mountain View when I worked in the fruit harvest. I reluctantly qualify as a "prune picker" and am acquainted with most aspects of apricot harvesting and processing (as it was done in those days!) I still enjoy eating apricots and cherries in any form and even prunes once in a while. The agricultural part of Mountain View's earlier history, along with the commercial enterprises and community development that accompanied it, is an important part of Mountain View's history. I was born in Mountain View at 217 Pettis Ave. And have lived here most of the time since.

My present "adventure" as MVHA president is a very rewarding experience. The spirit of friendliness and community among the members of MVHA has been very supportive. I thank everyone for their willing help and counsel. Our BBQ and Raffle, to be held August 1 at the Adobe, gives us an opportunity to enjoy our community.

Come and enjoy . . .

Craig Holden, President

Mark Your Calendar

Mountain View Union High School's annual ALUMNI DAY will be Saturday, October 2, at Cuesta Park. For details phone Ann Cozzolino — (650) 964 3550.

In Commemoration

Clotilda E. "Tillie" (Thoza) Masse: — Born in Oakland CA March 7, 1920. Died in Sunnyvale April 7, 2004. Daughter of the late Emily and John Thoza of Mtn. View. Beloved wife of 63 years to Earl Masse; dear sister of the late May Bontempi and Hortense Pritchard. Loving mother of Maxine Harrison and grandmother of Steve Rickman. She is also survived by numerous cousins, nieces, nephews and great nieces and nephews

She resided in Oakland until her family moved to Mountain View in 1924. She resided in Mountain View until 1956 when she moved to Sunnyvale. She was a graduate of Mountain View High School. She was a member with her husband of the Mountain View Historical Association.

Street Talk
By Barbara Kinchen

The May Newsletter asked about a different name for the present portion of Dana Street between Bush Street and Calderon Avenue. It was named Dexter Avenue when it was opened in 1905. At that time the street did not go all the way through to Calderon, but only to the rear line of Andrew J. Dexter's property. The city's 1928 block map shows it cut through, but still labeled as Dexter Street, not yet Dana.

New Question: At 2865 Marine Way, near San Antonio Road and north of Highway 101, there is a special memorial and plaque. Have you seen this? Are you aware of its significance? Do you know when it was placed there and by whom?

Membership Report
June Casey

Dues are $ 7.00 per year for an individual or $ 10.00 per year for a family membership. Life memberships are available for $ 100.00 per person.

Life Members	114
Honored Member	1
Annual Memberships	266
Total Memberships	381

Association Officers And Executive Committee

President	Craig Holden
Past President & Social	Ralph Faravelli
Vice President	Pat Figueroa
Sergeant At Arms	John Viscovich
Secretary	Margaret Peterson
Editor	Hilton Brown
Membership	June Casey
Programs and Publicity	Wally Erichsen
Hospitality	Dorothy Rich
Memorial/Remembrance	Edna Thompson
Ways & Means	Hip Telmont
Historical Data	Barbara Kinchen
Amplification/Recording	Albert Jehning

Regular meetings of the Mountain View Historical Association are held on the first Sunday of February, May, August and November. The Newsletter is mailed approximately two weeks before each meeting. Deadline for copy for the Newsletter is the third Sunday before each meeting.

Life, Honored and Special Members

Honored Member
Chris Castro

Life Members

O. Lennart Ahlkvist
Mario Ambra
J. Paul Arata
John Arrillaga
Marge Hingsberger Bailey
Godfrey Baumgartner
Barbara M. Bonetti
Robert J. Bonetti
Flora T. Brown
Hilton U. Brown, III
Laura Withrow Brown
Mary Ann Meek Buswell
Victor Calvo
Alice Churin Carvo
June Casey
William A. Dale
June Redwine de Larios
Cliff Del Carlo
Joseph Diaz
Kevin C. Duggan
Ruth Erichsen
Wallace J. Erichsen
Carmen Faravelli
Ralph Faravelli
Roger Fellows
Patricia Figueroa
Tom Frankum
Janice Mae Frankum
Nicholas B. Galiotto
Rebecca J. Galiotto
David O. Greene
Marion Grimm
Valerie E. Harris
Estelle Stagg Heffelfinger
Edward Henderson
Eleanor McGlynn Henderson
Charles Hirschbek
John L. Hirshbek
Norene Hogle
Audrey Jarvis Hoke
Craig Holden
Marjorie Holden
George Holden
Donald M. Holt
Virginia M. Holt
Harold Jarvis
Al Jehning
Leo E. Kalcic
R. Michael Kasperzak Jr.
Diane M. Keenan
Robert W. Kirby
Joe Kleitman
Helen Shearer Krogh
Barbara Krzyczkowska
Holly Urban Moore Leonard
Madeline Chargon Malovos
Betty E. McLaren
Thomas E. Miller
Frances Churin Mills
Betty C. Monroe
Gail Urban Moore
LaVerna Vincent Morgan
Mimi Mourkas
Don Newfarmer
Anne G. Nichols
Nancy Noe
Dana A. Peak
Matt Pear
Richard J. Peery
Harry Pinto
Ida Pinto
Milan Popovich
Massimo Prati
John P. Puppo
Edward L. Puppo
Anthhony J. Radisich
Marion R. Reginato
Louis F. Renner
Patricia J. Reyburn
Dorothy Holden Rich
Mark Rogge
Vivian Schatz
Robert C. Schick
Jamil Shaikh
Eugene D. Sharp
Elaine Marcetti Shearer
Margaret Garliepp Sideroff
Nancy L. Smith
Richard M. Smith
Jim Spangler
Martin J. Spangler
Austin Spencer
Honor Spitz
Brigitte Stafford
J. R. Stafford
H. Lee Stillens
Jane Culver Stoecklin
Linda Swan
Joseph Sweeney
Roberta Sweeney
Sally Moore Taboada
H. (Hip) A. Telmont
Charles Thompson
Edna Thompson
John Viscovich
Arthur Walton
Patricia Walton
Paula Weaver
Robert Weaver
Denise Williams
Bill Wissel
Cornelia Matijasevich Whitlow
Lorraine A. Wormald
Mary Lou Zoglin

MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION

REGULAR MEETING

ELEVENTH ANNUAL BARBECUE & RAFFLE

SUNDAY, AUGUST 1, 2004
1:00 P.M.

THE ADOBE BUILDING
MOFFETT BLVD AND
CENTRAL EXPRESSWAY

MEMBERSHIP: Any person who signifies interest in the aims of this Association and who pays the specified annual dues may become a member of the Association.

AIMS: The aims of this Association are: to gather and preserve historical data relative to the early settlement and development of the area in and around the present City of Mountain View; to collect, record, edit and publish a history of the pioneering activities of this area; to preserve historic objects and places; to cooperate with other organizations in the Santa Clara Valley on projects deemed worthy by our membership.

MEMBERSHIP APPLICATION

NAME: _____

ADDRESS: _____

_____

_____

TELEPHONE: _____

TYPE: NEW_____ RENEWAL_____

Regular Member $ 7.00/yr
Family Membership $10.00/yr
Life Member $100.00.

Make Check Payable to:

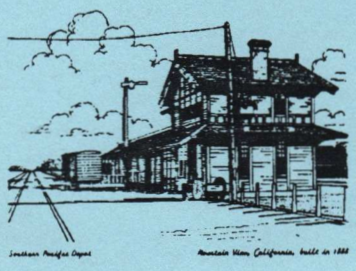
Mountain View Historical Association
P.O. Box 252, Mountain View, CA 94042

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P.O. BOX 252
MOUNTAIN VIEW, CA 94042

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